The language of Business Analytics
A Glossary of 38 Essential Terms

01 Foundational Concepts of Analytics

① Business Analytics

Definition: Business Analytics is using data to help business make better decisions. It combines statistics and business knowledge to solve real problems. Unlike BI, it also looks forward - not just at what already happened.

Examples: Pick n Pay might use Business Analytics to predict which products will run low on stock and recommend reorder quantities

② Data Analytics

Definition: Data Analytics is the broader process of examining raw data to find patterns and conclusions. Business Analytics is actually a type of Data Analytics. The difference is that Data Analytics applies to any field, not just business.

Example: A hospital might use Data Analytics on patient records to identify who is likely to be readmitted within 30 days

③ Business Intelligence (BI)

Definition: BI refers to the tools and processes used to turn raw data into reports, charts, and dashboards. It is mostly backward-looking - it shows what already happened. Unlike Business Analytics, it does not explain why or recommend next steps.